

MUSTARD SEED

Faith-Driven Business Incubator & Venture Capital

Empowering Small Businesses Through Embedded Expertise

The Problem

Why small businesses fail — and current solutions fall short

60%

of UK startups fail
within 5 years

73%

of owners lack
a critical skill

15%

decline in bank
lending to SMEs

12 wks

avg accelerator
programme length

Small businesses fail because they lack management, financial, and marketing expertise.
Existing support is too short (12-week cohorts), too shallow (mentorship only), or too expensive (consulting fees).

The gap: No one offers long-term, embedded operational expertise with aligned incentives — until now.

The Solution

Embedded growth partnership — not advice from the sidelines

Embed

We work inside your business — finance, marketing, ops

Align

10-15% equity, staged.
We profit only when you succeed.

Separate

Training & financial aid
priced independently.
Pay for what you need.

Pilot

3-month trial with
milestones & mutual
exit rights

Unlike Techstars (13 weeks, 5%, mentorship) or Seedcamp (7%, passive seed investment), Mustard Seed provides months of hands-on operational integration. Your equity pays for embedded management consulting — training and financial services are separate, affordable fees.

"From the smallest seed grows the largest tree" — We invest in potential, not pedigree.

Market Opportunity

A £12.8B market with a wide-open niche

TAM

£12.8B

UK small business
support services

SAM

£1.4B

Growth-seeking SMEs
open to equity

SOM

£500K–1M

8-10 portfolio companies
in first 3 years

Key Market Drivers

- 390,000 new UK businesses annually
- Bank lending to SMEs down 15%
- 73% of owners lack critical expertise
- Incubator market growing 7.9% CAGR
- £100M UK gov Innovation Accelerator
- Faith investing: £26B+ (Church Investors Group)

Revenue Model & Pricing

Equity for core consulting — everything else is fee-based

Equity (10-15%)

Embedded management consulting. Staged milestones.

Core
service

Training Fees

£150-£1,500/session.
Open to all businesses.

Immediate
cash flow

Financial Advisory

£300-£2,000 per engagement. Separate from equity.

Immediate
cash flow

Consulting Fees

£75-£150/hr for non-affiliated businesses.

Immediate
cash flow

Staged Equity Model

Stage 1 (3 months): 3-5% equity earned after diagnostic & pilot milestones

Stage 2 (months 4-12): 3-5% earned on growth KPIs

Stage 3 (month 12+): Remaining equity on independence milestones

Either party can exit at any stage boundary — Mustard Seed keeps only earned equity

Competitive Landscape

Positioned where no one else is

Traditional Accelerators

Programme	Investment	Equity	Duration	Embedded?
Techstars London	\$220K (SAFE + CEA)	5% min	13 weeks	No
Seedcamp	€75K (up to €200K)	7% (or 3%)	Ongoing	No
BGV	£60K	6-7%	6 weeks	No
Entrepreneur First	\$125K (SAFE)	8%	Multi-phase	No

Faith-Based Organisations

Organisation	Model	Investment?	Equity?	Embedded?
CREO Ventures	4-wk accelerator + venture lab	None	None	No
Navigators UK (NEC)	Peer entrepreneur community	None	None	No
Faith Driven VC	Christian VC fund	\$100K min (LPs)	VC terms	No

Mustard Seed's Unique Position

Only player combining: Equity investment + Embedded staff + Faith values + Separated pricing

- Traditional accelerators: funding + mentorship, but no operational integration
- Faith organisations: community + values, but no investment capital
- Mustard Seed: 10-15% equity for deep integration, with training & finance priced separately

Financial Projections

Bootstrap-first — designed to survive from Year 1

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Revenue	£40K	£90K	£175K	£330K	£520K
Costs	£34K	£115K	£208K	£278K	£332K
Net Profit/(Loss)	£5.9K	(£24.5K)	(£32.9K)	£52.1K	£187.8K
Portfolio Equity Value	£30K	£120K	£350K	£700K	£1.4M
Portfolio Companies	3	7	10	14	18

Key Metrics

Year 1
Cash Positive

Yes

Startup
Cost

~£8.5K

Y5 Enterprise
Value

£1.6M

Founder-Led
Year 1

Solo

Y1 profitable as solo founder. Y2-3 dip during hiring/expansion. Full profitability returns Y4. Stress test: even with 0 portfolio companies, consulting covers costs.

Scenario Analysis

Survivable across all scenarios

Scenario	Y1 Companies	Y5 Revenue	Y5 Equity Value	Break-Even	Survivable?
Optimistic	4	£680K	£2.2M	Year 1	Yes
Base Case	2-3	£520K	£1.4M	Year 1 (dip Y2-3)	Yes
Pessimistic	1	£280K	£400K	Year 2	Yes
Stress Test	0	£150K	£100K	Year 3	Yes — consulting covers costs

Why Every Scenario Survives

- Fee-based services generate revenue from month 1
- Solo founder = near-zero fixed costs
- No external funding required to launch
- Equity is upside — not survival dependency
- Staged equity limits exposure if companies fail
- Pilot structure allows course-correction
- Hiring triggered by revenue, not assumptions
- Worst case: profitable lifestyle consulting business

Pilot Launch Strategy

Prove the model before scaling



Expansion triggers: Portfolio 4+ companies → hire consultant | Revenue £150K+ → consider seed round | No trigger → no spend

MUSTARD SEED

"If you have faith as small as a mustard seed...
nothing will be impossible for you."

— Matthew 17:20

Thank You
Questions & Discussion